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BIM Adoption in Tunisia

Building a Smarter Future

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المدرسة الوطنية للهندسة المعمارية والتعمير
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Welcome & Introduction

On May 28, 2025, the South Mediterranean University (MedTech), in collaboration with BIM Africa, proudly hosted BIM Day Tunisia 2025—a high-level, multidisciplinary forum dedicated to accelerating the adoption of Building Information Modeling (BIM) in Tunisia and across the African continent. The event convened over 200 professionals, academics, public officials, and industry leaders, creating a dynamic platform for critical reflection, strategic dialogue, and collaborative engagement around the digital transformation of the construction and built environment sectors.

Supported by Archetype Group and our Platinum Sponsor ST2I – Autodesk Gold Partner, the conference emphasized the transformative role of digital technologies in enhancing construction efficiency, sustainability, and governance. BIM Day Tunisia 2025 marked a significant milestone in national and regional efforts to advance a more structured and holistic approach to digital construction practices.

The event's partnership with BIM Africa, a leading continental network promoting BIM knowledge and capacity building, amplified the scope of the discussions, offering comparative insights from various African contexts and fostering regional cooperation. This collaboration reaffirmed Tunisia's strategic commitment to align with broader African digitalization agendas and to contribute meaningfully to the collective advancement of BIM across the continent.

Objectives of BIM Day Tunisia 2025

The primary objectives of BIM Day Tunisia 2025 were to:

- Raise national and regional awareness of BIM as a process-driven methodology that extends beyond software to include standards, workflows, policy frameworks, and organizational transformation.
- Showcase international and African best practices, providing actionable insights that can inform the development of a national BIM strategy tailored to Tunisia's socio-economic and institutional context.
- Identify structural and operational challenges hindering BIM adoption in Tunisia, including gaps in regulation, skills development, inter-agency coordination, and access to digital infrastructure.
- Promote cross-sectoral collaboration by fostering dialogue between academia, public institutions, and private industry to ensure cohesive and coordinated BIM implementation.
- Support education and capacity building by advocating for the integration of BIM competencies in academic curricula and the development of certification programs for professionals and public-sector stakeholders.
- Strengthen regional cooperation by engaging with BIM Africa and other continental partners to harmonize digital construction standards and promote knowledge transfer across borders.
- Chart a national roadmap for BIM integration in Tunisia's construction sector, with clearly defined milestones, governance mechanisms, and performance indicators.
  Through these objectives, BIM Day Tunisia 2025 aimed not only to catalyze the digital transformation of Tunisia's construction ecosystem but also to contribute to a broader continental vision of a collaborative, data-driven, and future-ready built environment.

Section 1: BIM in Tunisia

Dr. Bilel Succar – Introduction to BIM



Dr. Succar emphasized that BIM is a holistic methodology encompassing processes, workflows, and policies, not merely software. He identified three essential drivers:

- A strong mandate or champion at leadership level
- Initial budget allocation and ROI patience
- A long-term strategic vision

He reviewed global best practices: UK's Level 2 mandate, Singapore's incentives, and Nordic open standards. Tunisia must tailor a national roadmap by integrating these lessons with local context.

Anis Mahmoud – National Digitalization Report



Anis Mahmoud presented insights from the Arab Institute of Business Leaders report, showing only 3% BIM penetration in Tunisia's construction sector despite high opportunity recognition.
He recommended:

- Establishing a central BIM authority with a 20M TND budget over 5 years
- Launching 'Plan BIM Tunisie 2025' as a shared repository for standards and tools
- Coordinated public–private working groups to drive policy and pilot projects

Mrs. Sofia Rihane & Mrs. Houda Zeidi representing Tunisia's Housing Land Agency



Mrs. Sofia Rihane, representing Tunisia's Housing Land Agency, discussed the public-sector requirements for BIM in land development and housing projects. She highlighted:

- The need for standardized digital deliverables in public tenders
- Data interoperability for integrating GIS and BIM workflows
- Capacity building within municipal agencies to review and approve BIM submissions

Her insights underscored the importance of harmonizing agency mandates with national BIM strategies.

Sami Chebbi – Private-Sector Deployment



Mr. Chebbi showcased prefabricated hospital and housing initiatives using BIM-led workflows.
Key benefits included early clash detection, reduced rework, and faster permit approvals. He highlighted challenges in software affordability and proposed negotiations with vendors for site licenses and local value creation.

Dr. Ons Mansour Najjar Architect - Academic - BIM Consultant



Dr. Najjar emphasized the persistent "awareness-implementation gap" in Building Information Modeling (BIM), where it is still predominantly perceived as a mere technical tool rather than a comprehensive process driving digital transformation in construction. She advocated for the systematic integration of BIM modules into architecture and engineering curricula, ensuring that future professionals develop the necessary competencies early in their academic training. Additionally, she called for the strengthening of practitioner certification programs to promote a deeper, more consistent application of BIM across project lifecycles. This dual approach would facilitate a paradigm shift, enabling BIM to be leveraged not just as a standalone tool but as a foundational element of collaborative, data-driven, and sustainable project delivery. Dr. Najjar's recommendations aim to foster a more holistic adoption of BIM, maximizing its potential to enhance efficiency, innovation, and interdisciplinary coordination in the built environment. A strong partnership between academia and industry is essential to bridge the BIM skills gap, ensuring that educational curricula align with real-world demands while empowering professionals with the latest digital competencies for transformative project delivery.

Prof. Jamel Neji – Academic & Research Roles



Prof. Neji advocated creating a national Center of Excellence for BIM research, offering joint university–industry pilot programs and embedding certification in public-sector hiring.

Section 2: BIM in Africa

Continental Insights

African BIM leaders showcased regional initiatives, highlighting diverse approaches adapted to local contexts while addressing shared challenges such as pressing infrastructure demands, skills shortages, and fragmented regulatory frameworks. Key presentations underscored efforts to promote BIM adoption through localized training programs, public-private partnerships, and policy advocacy to standardize digital construction practices. Some nations are leveraging BIM to enhance large-scale infrastructure projects, while others focus on capacity-building to bridge the technical skills gap. Despite varying maturity levels in BIM implementation, a common theme emerged: the need for collaborative strategies that align education, industry needs, and government support to drive sustainable digital transformation. These discussions reinforced the importance of context-specific to accelerate BIM integration across the continent.

Kehinde Adeyemi (Nigeria)



Detailed the government-led 'Digital Construction Academy' initiative, which offers subsidized BIM training modules to over 1,000 students annually. The program partners with global software vendors and local universities to fast-track graduates into public-sector infrastructure projects.

Uboho Othman(West Africa)



Described grassroots practitioner networks that have aligned with BuildingSmart International to deliver Level 2 BIM certification workshops. These networks leverage online platforms and local hubs in Ghana and Senegal to upskill 200+ professionals in the past year.

Deena El-Mahdy (Egypt)



Deena El-Mahdy delivered a talk about the integration of BIM and 3D printing in construction, emphasizing the role of nature and how we can draw inspiration from insects. She highlighted how insects build their colonies using earthen-based materials, which aligns with advanced, environmentally respectful construction techniques that incorporate passive design strategies. Deena showcased several construction projects she has been involved in, culminating with the 3D-printed TOVA project in Spain. This project was constructed using earthen materials excavated from the site and printed with a Wasp crane printer as part of a program by IAAC, Barcelona.

Nejib Adouane (Morocco)



Nebib Adouane opened his presentation by clarifying that he represents Morocco's Ministry of Equipment rather than Algeria. He walked the audience through Morocco's recently published "Digital Construction Strategy," which mandates BIM model submissions for all government-funded projects above a set threshold. He then detailed the roles of three new regional BIM offices, in Rabat, Casablanca, and Marrakech, that offer certification courses and hands-on CDE (Common Data Environment) workshops, noting that over 120 public-sector engineers have already completed training. Nebib also highlighted a pilot "Smart Infrastructure" project in Tangier, where a full digital-twin workflow was deployed to manage seawall reinforcement, resulting in a 28 percent reduction in site rework. He closed by inviting neighboring countries to adopt Morocco's openBIM guidelines and to participate in the Maghreb BIM Forum scheduled for September in Casablanca, aimed at harmonizing standards across North Africa.

Mahmoud Adly (Egypt)



Shared mega-project case studies, including the Golden Gate Elevated Highway and Cairo Arts & Culture Complex. He highlighted cross-border collaboration between Egyptian and Emirati firms using IFC-based workflows, resulting in a 20% faster design iteration cycle.

ST2I Autodesk (Platinum Sponsor)

ST2I Autodesk showcased its comprehensive cloud-based BIM platform, emphasizing three main capabilities:

1. E-Permitting in Dubai: Enabled digital submission of 3D models for permitting, cutting approval times by 50%.
2. Digital Twins in Johor: Demonstrated real-time asset management via integrated BIM and IoT data for urban development projects.
3. Trial Offer: Tunisian attendees received a six-month trial of Autodesk Forma and Build, facilitating hands-on experience with advanced collaborative workflows.

Section 3: Panel Discussion – Shaping the Roadmap

The roundtable convened policymakers, industry leaders, and academics to chart Tunisia's BIM roadmap. Discussions centered on regulatory frameworks, data governance, diversity, and capacity building. Highlights included:

David Delgado (Spain)



Proposed a template for BIM mandates in public tenders, including tiered requirements based on project size and value. He recommended embedding BIM clauses in standard contract documents and offering government-backed training grants.

Dahbia Meddahi (Algeria)



Addressed data governance, advocating for a centralized CDE with role-based access controls to ensure data privacy and compliance with international standards. She stressed the need for legislative support to govern digital project data.

Faten Hussein (Tunisia)



Highlighted the importance of diversity and gender inclusion in digital construction. She proposed mentorship programs, scholarships, and leadership tracks for women to create a more equitable professional ecosystem.

Prof. Jamel Neji (Tunisia)



Reiterated the necessity of academia–industry partnerships. He suggested joint research grants, internship pipelines, and co-developed curricula to retain talent and align educational outcomes with market needs.